

Kea

Nestor notabilis

"scaly" body
feathers



The only alpine parrot, the kea is a great tourist attraction—investigating cars, bags, and clothing with its hooked bill—but many locals deem it a pest. Keas eat roots, berries, and insects, but came under scrutiny in the 1860s because of suspicions that they attacked sheep. Bounties were offered and more than 150,000 were killed between 1870 and 1970. By then there were only 5,000 keas left and protective measures were taken, but their numbers still declined and have yet to recover.



- ↔ 19 in (48 cm)
- ⚖ 29 oz (825 g)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🍷 Fruit, insects, grubs, carrion
- 🏠 🌳 🌿 🌱 🌾
- 📍 New Zealand

◁ ALPINE SURVIVOR

The kea is exceptionally intelligent—a quality that is vital to its survival in its harsh mountain habitat.

Kakapo

Strigops habroptila

blunt, round,
owl-like head



The biggest, heaviest, and only flightless parrot, the kakapo is one of the world's longest-lived birds—averaging 95 years and reaching 120. Males compete for females in a lek, digging shallow bowls in the ground, perhaps to help amplify their calls, which continue for up to eight hours a night for several months.

- ↔ 25 in (64 cm)
- ⚖ 5 lb (2 kg)
- ⊗ Critically endangered
- 🍷 Plants
- 🏠 🌳 🌿 🌱 🌾
- 📍 New Zealand

◁ RARE BIRD

Just 126 kakapos were known in 2014, with only six chicks having hatched since 2011. The best chance of the species' survival rests on the birds having been moved to offshore islands free from predators.



Kiwis are the **only** birds in the world with **external nostrils** at the **tip of the bill**

